

Samson Endale Mergissa

Senior Software Engineer

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Profile

Certified Laravel Developer with 9+ years of experience, including success in remote teams across Europe and India. My extensive experience with Laravel is evident in [my contributions](#) to the Laravel code base and [packages featured](#) on Laravel News. I bring a problem-solving approach and a team-oriented mindset to every project, constantly learning and exceeding expectations.

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer and Tech Lead, Part-Time ([Makiba PLC](#)) Addis Ababa, Ethiopia 04/2020 - present

- As the project lead of a rapidly expanding logistics startup, I led the development of Agelgil, a Laravel-based platform leveraging GIS to optimize the delivery of essential goods for government clients. By streamlining distribution and ensuring transparency, Agelgil has reached 250,000 active customers in just four years.

Senior Laravel Developer and Project Lead, Remote ([Inisev Ltd](#)) Malta, Europe 04/2022 - 04/2024

- Designed and Implemented the backend and led the development of [RateltAll.com](#), a social networking website.
- Designed and developed over ten micro-services that seamlessly integrate with the central system to deliver [follow.it API feeds](#) feature for more than 10 million active users.
- Designed and developed several in-house tools used by a highly diverse international team use on internal projects.

Senior Software Engineer, Remote ([Popson Cloud Ltd.](#)) Pune, Maharashtra, India 08/2021 - 02/2022

- In just six months, I led the design and development of a user-friendly cloud service management platform built on Apache CloudStack. This white-label solution offered functionalities similar to industry leaders like DigitalOcean and Linode, catering to a specific market segment with a focus on ease of use. The project's success was a result of collaboration with a skilled infrastructure team and a talented UI designer. Notably, the company rebranded as [stackconsole.io](#) after my departure, signifying the product's lasting impact and potential for various white-label applications.

Lead Cyber Security Analyst ([Information Network Security Agency](#)) Addis Ababa, Ethiopia 09/2016 - 08/2021

- Leading a dedicated team, I spearhead the research, design, development, and rigorous testing of secure communication products trusted by several of the country's highest-level government agencies.
- During my time at the organization, I focused on strengthening cybersecurity. I conducted comprehensive security audits of various government systems, identifying vulnerabilities and developing effective mitigation strategies. In addition to my audit work, I also contributed to the organization's knowledge base by writing and presenting a research paper titled "Amharic Language Letter Frequency Distribution" at their first InHouse cybersecurity conference.

Startup Co-Founder, Part-Time ([xLab Digital Solutions PLC](#)) Addis Ababa, Ethiopia 12/2018 - 12/2019

- I created, developed and directed the most lucrative product that our company offered. This product handles and streamlines the client's SMS-based Value Added Service (VAS) by integrating with EthioTelecom SMS Center (SMSC) through SMPP protocol. By utilizing the Laravel queue system, we were able to enhance resilience and boost sales, giving us an edge over our competitors.

Startup Co-Founder, Part-Time ([Andegna Systems PLC](#)) Addis Ababa, Ethiopia 02/2018 - 10/2018

- Starting as a school project, my teammates and I undertook the ambitious challenge of developing the Graduate Verification System, a web-based solution aimed at tackling academic document forgery. This project, built with Laravel 5.5 (LTS), involved designing a centralized repository of graduate information. The project's potential for national impact garnered significant media attention, even earning a feature on national television. Though we attempted to turn it into a successful business, the experience provided valuable insights into project development, market validation, and what it takes to make a business successful.

Software Engineer, Part-Time ([PCODE Private Limited Company PLC](#)) Bahir Dar, Ethiopia 06/2015 - 07/2016

- During my part-time software engineering role, I successfully delivered a full-scale web-based solution for a leading client in the hotel and resort sector. This included designing and developing a custom Laravel-based CMS, resulting in a user-friendly platform that streamlined content management for the client.

Software Engineer, Intern ([Epion Computer Solutions PLC](#)) Addis Ababa, Ethiopia 10/2014 - 02/2015

- During my internship, I developed a business directory platform called [addisbiz.com](#) using Laravel 4.2, which was the latest version available at the time. This project was my first experience working with Laravel and version control systems. I also developed an open source [andegna/calender package](#) on GitHub that converts Ethiopian dates to the Gregorian calendar, which I used for this platform. I released it under the MIT license.
- In addition, I used Drupal to develop a website for a clinic and contributed to the development of two other commercial websites.

Education

BSc in Software Engineering (*Bahir Dar University*)

Bahir Dar, Ethiopia 01/2012 - 06/2016

Graduated with Honors - *cum laude*

Awarded for academic excellence in Computer Science and Engineering (Software Engineering stream) at Bahir Dar University (class of 2016).

Skills

- **Programming Languages:** PHP, JavaScript, Java, Kotlin, Go, Python, C
- **Laravel:** Laravel Framework, Lumen, Composer, Blade Template, Livewire, Filament, Eloquent ORM, Octane, Laravel Sanctum, API Development (RESTful, GraphQL), API documentation (Swagger, OpenAPI), Laravel Ecosystem, MVC
- **Web Development:** HTML, HTML5, CSS, CSS3, Tailwind, jQuery, Vue.js, SQLite, MySQL, PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Redis, MongoDB, Git, Github, Github Action, GitLab
- **Cybersecurity:** Secure coding practices, Vulnerability assessment, Threat modeling, Security testing (penetration testing, code auditing), Encryption, Authentication and authorization, Access policy
- **Additional Technical Skills:** Cloud Platforms (DigitalOcean, AWS), Docker, Web Servers (Nginx, Caddy), Linux (basic administration), Unit Testing (PHPUnit, Pest, Laravel Dusk), DevOps, Application performance and scalability
- **Interpersonal and Leadership Skills:** Problem-solving, Teamwork, Communication, Problem-solving, Time management, Decision-making, Project management, Technical Leadership, Mentoring

Languages

- **English** [Professional Working Proficiency]
- **Amharic** [Native]